



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

brāhmaṇārthe gavārthe vā dehatyāgo 'n.upaskṛtaḥ | 10.62a
strī.bālābhyupapattau ca bāhyānām siddhikāraṇam || 62 || 10.62c 10.62cv/: M
ahimsā satyam asteyaṁ śaucam indriyanigrahaḥ | 10.63a
etaṁ sāmāsikaṁ dharmaṁ cāturvarṇye 'bravīn manuḥ || 63 || 10.63c

— Manusmṛti, 10.1.1.8. Advance to Higher Classes (Chapter 8), Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The Manusmṛiti, in these verses, outlines paths of sacrifice and essential virtues applicable to all, regardless of social standing. The willingness to sacrifice one's life for a Brahmin (representing spiritual knowledge), for the protection of a cow (symbolizing sustenance and non-violence), or for the sake of women and children (representing vulnerability and future generations), is considered a path to spiritual attainment even for those outside the traditional four-class system. This highlights the importance of selfless action and the protection of dharma, even at the cost of one's own life. It's not a call to reckless abandon, but an emphasis on prioritizing higher values over self-preservation in extreme circumstances.

More universally, Manu emphasizes five fundamental virtues: non-violence (ahimsa), truthfulness (satyam), non-stealing (asteyam), purity (śaucam), and control of the senses (indriyanigraha). These are not merely rules, but rather the cornerstones of a righteous life, applicable to everyone, irrespective of their caste. These virtues, taken together, form a concise code of conduct that promotes inner peace and harmonious relationships.

In modern life, these principles remain profoundly relevant. While literal self-sacrifice may rarely be required, the spirit of prioritizing dharma over personal gain can manifest in countless ways. It might involve standing up for what is right, even when it's unpopular, protecting the vulnerable, or dedicating your resources to a cause greater than yourself. Practicing non-violence extends beyond physical harm to include our words and thoughts, fostering compassion and understanding. Truthfulness builds trust and strengthens relationships. Non-stealing encompasses not just material possessions, but also time, credit, and opportunities. Purity refers to both physical cleanliness and the purity of your intentions. Control of the senses means mastering your desires and impulses, leading to greater self-control and inner peace. By embracing these virtues, you can create a more just, compassionate, and fulfilling life.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

How can you more consciously embody one of these five virtues in your daily interactions and decisions, starting today?